

Unfolded Playtesting Report

May 7, 2025

A. Playtesting Goals

At the time of creating the playtesting build, we were still ironing different pieces of our game. We had also run into a pretty big bug where the .umap file that held our level was not syncing amongst the different team members' githubs. That meant the focus of our playtesting questions were about specific components and mechanics of our game. The form started with a "general impressions" section followed by two main sections, gameplay mechanics and game experience.

The gameplay mechanics had questions about the feel of the environment and how well it worked in relation to the gameplay mechanics we had implemented. For example, did people feel the environment needed to be bigger because the knockback feature kicked them out of the map? Did players get softlocked anywhere?

The game experience questions focused if we had conveyed the emotions and vibe that we were aiming for. For example, did our assets contribute to the spooky/creepy vibe we were going for.

By focusing on the answers to these smaller questions, we felt that we would be able to fine tune certain parameters in our game that would affect the overall experience.

B. Original Survey Form and Playtesters' Responses

Link to Survey Form: [Unfolded Playtesting Form](#)

Playtester Responses: [Unfolded Playtest Feedback \(Responses\)](#)

C. List of Emails of Students who Playtested

Participants	
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D. Developer Notes from the Playtest Session

- People broke the game in ways we didn't expect. With the combination of the very strong knockback and the dash some people caused the player and some enemies to fly off the map
- People were laughing over how absurd the knockback was, one player even kept playing over and over to try and find different ways to break the game and interact with the enemies and fly off the map
- The fire button was initially right click which confused many players who were expecting it to be left click. Players were also unaware that there was a dash until told.

E. Summary of Main Take-Aways from Playtesters

- People liked our movement systems and the character designs of the player character and enemies but they struggled with getting softlocked often, or they didn't know where to go
- The map needs to be bigger, specifically the abyss room
- The wall disappearing mechanic felt too choppy and it didn't feel intentional
- The knockback from running into the enemies is way too strong
- Currently there is no real "horror" or "spooky" feel to the game, but people can tell we are working our way up to it
- It's hard to tell what the story/point of the game is

To summarize those bullet points, we mainly needed to fix up all the ways the players were getting softlocked and try to make it so that there is a spooky ambience in the game, as in its playtesting state there was none.

F. Changes Made to the Game (if any) Based on the Playtesting

Expanding the environment definitely helped to reduce the amount of times a player can get soft locked in the game. For the wall disappearing mechanic, we created a new texture that wasn't as choppy and made it so that it was based on the player's distance from the camera so that the disappearing walls looked like an intentional change.

The knockback was reduced to a more manageable level and people no longer fall out of the level. In terms of narrative building, a dialogue system was added and stylized to provide the player with more context about what they were doing.